

Article | 15 June 2026

Webinar: The Iran deal and what it means for macro and markets

Join ING's economists and strategists for a live webinar on 17 June to discuss what the latest Middle East breakthrough could mean for energy prices, rate expectations and financial markets. Sign up [here](#)



The US and Iran have said they've agreed an interim deal that reopens the Strait of Hormuz and extends a fragile ceasefire. Oil prices have fallen but plenty of questions remain – not least whether a deal can stand the test of time.

[Join ING's economists and strategists](#) for their first thoughts on what a deal could mean for the prospect of interest rate hikes and the broader impact on financial markets. You'll discover:

- Why energy prices could go higher again, even with a deal in place
- Whether the European Central Bank is still on track for a second rate hike this summer
- If a deal could unlock a move in EUR/USD to 1.20 by year-end
- Scenarios for swap rates and the ripple effects through bond markets

Details

Date: Wednesday 17 June

Time: 0900 BST/1000 CEST

The webinar will last 30 minutes, including a Q&A session at the end.

The event will take place online and the waiting room will open 60 minutes ahead of the scheduled start time.

A joining link will be emailed following registration and you will receive a reminder email 10 minutes before the scheduled start time.

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Article | 15 June 2026

UNITED KINGDOM

Iran deal takes Bank of England rate hike back off table

If the deal endures and oil starts flowing again, UK inflation would likely stay below 4% and enable the Bank of England to avoid a rate hike this summer. We expect a 7-2 vote in favour of no change this Thursday



The US-Iran deal has nudged the pendulum back towards a prolonged pause

A rate hike at this Thursday's Bank of England decision had already become highly unlikely. And thereafter, the US-Iran deal has nudged the pendulum back towards a prolonged pause. Markets now price just a 25% chance of a July hike and only one rate increase this year, down from a peak of three.

Our view has long been that the Bank is somewhere between doing nothing and hiking once – and 4% inflation is an important line in the sand. The Bank argued last summer that when it exceeds that level, it's more likely that inflation becomes more embedded and second-round effects more likely.

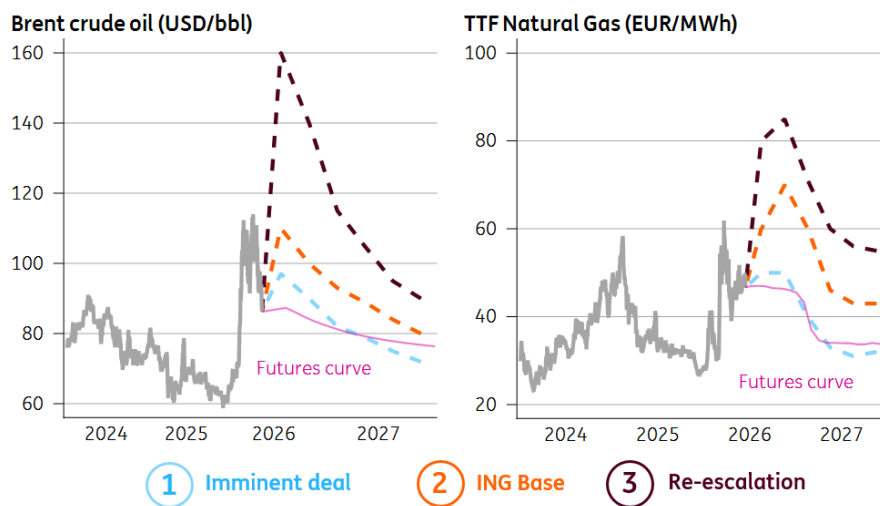
With energy prices where they are today, 4% inflation is unlikely. Natural gas futures for next winter and beyond are back to pre-war levels – and they play a big role in setting the quarterly household energy price cap. That cap is already set to rise 13% in July but if nothing changes, it's likely to fall 7% in October. That would keep UK inflation between 3-3.5% through the autumn/winter. The bar for a rate hike wouldn't be met. Remember, the Bank argues that

simply not cutting rates, as was otherwise likely, amounts to a de facto tightening of policy.

That said, our commodities team [sees a decent case](#) for energy prices to move higher again – even if the deal agreed this weekend endures. Oil inventories will need rebuilding, while Europe still needs to replenish its gas storage, which sits well below the seasonal average – at a time when Asia will increasingly compete with Europe for LNG supplies.

Even in a scenario where the disruption in the Strait of Hormuz eases significantly through June, our team sees oil averaging \$97/bbl in 3Q. Natural gas prices could inch a little higher, too.

ING's scenarios for global energy prices

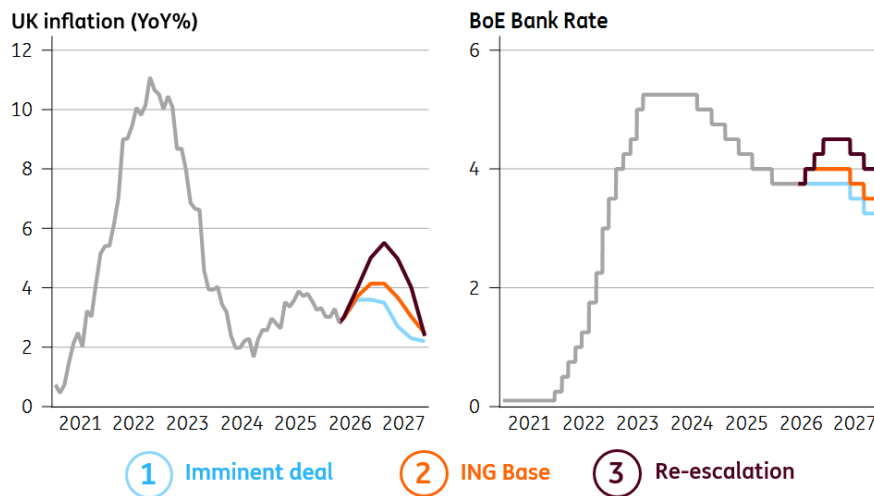


Source: Macrobond, ING

That still probably doesn't warrant rate hikes, though. Our forecasts show inflation would peak around 3.8% in that scenario. And importantly, a sustained reopening of the Strait of Hormuz would shift the balance of risks on inflation. The tail risk of a long, messy period of disruption would diminish.

The problem comes if the US-Iran deal unravels or fails to prevent another summer energy spike. In a scenario where the Strait of Hormuz stays disrupted through June and July, our team reckons oil briefly spikes to \$120/bbl in July and natural gas prices surge. That would take inflation above 4% next winter and would make it very hard for the Bank not to hike this summer. That was loosely our global base case when we released our latest numbers last week – and it's why we tentatively added a July rate hike to our forecasts.

What ING's energy scenarios mean for the UK



Source: Macrobond, ING

All of that now looks less likely again, though time will tell. And as for this week's meeting, in the absence of either new forecasts or a press conference, the main question is how many officials join Chief Economist Huw Pill in voting for an immediate rate hike.

Here, we're likely to see a return to the old battle lines that existed on the committee before the war began. Back then, some officials – including Pill – argued that price setting behaviour had permanently shifted since the pandemic in a way that would keep inflation structurally higher. Megan Greene, who subscribes to that view, has all-but-said she'll vote for a hike this week. Catherine Mann, another long-time hawk, could join her. We're expecting a 7-2 vote in favour of no change this week.

But another four members – five if you include Governor Andrew Bailey, who sits somewhere between the two camps – argue that the risk of second round inflation effects have diminished since the last energy shock four years ago. And the latest data suggests they are right.

Headline inflation got pretty close to 4% last year on rising food prices. Yet the latest data shows minimal signs of that morphing into a more persistent bout of price pressure. The jobs market is still under pressure. And private-sector wage growth is likely to fall below 3% in the short-term, which is below the level the Bank said in February was consistent with a 2% inflation target over the medium-term.

That's ultimately why we expect a return to rate cuts in 2027 – something markets aren't currently pricing.

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Article | 12 June 2026

FX RATES UNITED STATES

Kevin Warsh navigates a hawkish Fed shift

Improved economic momentum and elevated inflation suggest the Federal Reserve will acknowledge the possibility of a future rate hike via new forecasts. New Chair Kevin Warsh isn't a fan of forward guidance though and will likely remain non-committal in his first press conference



We doubt that new Fed Chair Kevin Warsh will vote for a rate cut, despite Trump's demands for lower rates

Inflation and regained momentum swing hawkishly

Optimism is rising that we are inching closer to a deal to reopen the Strait of Hormuz, but even with a deal, global energy prices will likely remain elevated until at least early 2027. European and Asian inventory rebuilding will keep a strong bid in markets through the second half of the year. At the same time, uncertainty over the scale of damage to infrastructure in the region and the willingness of shipping companies to put their vessels back potentially into harms way, should the deal subsequently fail, limits supply. In consequence, we expect no real relief from higher prices this year.

The US economy is more insulated from Middle East risks than most countries due to its energy independence, but it is not immune. An abundance of natural gas and a lack of storage mean domestic prices have fallen, which is helpful for keeping utility bills in check. However, higher motor fuel costs are adding to cost pressures with spillover effects already in freight

rates and airline fares, with inflation breaching a three-year high of 4.2%.

Amid rising inflation, business surveys point to 2-2.5% GDP growth, the economy is adding jobs and equity markets are at record highs. Understandably, market expectations of potential Federal Reserve rate hikes have increased, with a 25bp rate hike priced in this year and around a 50% chance of a second such move next year.

Unanimous vote for stable rates

In terms of Wednesday's FOMC meeting, we expect the Fed to leave monetary policy unchanged, but we do expect a statement that puts greater emphasis on the possibility of an interest rate rise. Remember that last time, Stephen Miran, who has since vacated his governor position for newly appointed Fed Chair Kevin Warsh, voted for a rate cut while three other FOMC members – Beth Hammack, Neel Kashkari and Lorie Logan – wanted the removal of the perceived “easing bias”. The minutes to the meeting subsequently suggested more officials were uncomfortable with the language of the statement, and so we expect to see a unanimous vote in favour of keeping policy unchanged, but with a hawkish shift on language.

With Miran gone, we doubt that Kevin Warsh will choose to dissent against all the other 11 members by voting for a rate cut, despite his appointment as chair by a president who has demanded lower rates.

ING's expectations for the Federal Reserve's central projections

	2026	2027	2028	Longer run
Change in real GDP (4Q YoY%)	2.0	2.4	2.1	2.0
Previous Fed projection (Mar)	2.4	2.3	2.1	2.0
Unemployment rate (% year end)	4.3	4.3	4.2	4.2
Previous Fed projection (Mar)	4.4	4.3	4.2	4.2
Core PCE inflation (4Q YoY%)	3.1	2.3	2.0	-
Previous Fed projection (Mar)	2.7	2.2	2.0	-
Federal funds rate (year end)	3.6	3.4	3.1	3.1
Previous Fed projection (Mar)	3.4	3.1	3.1	3.1

Source: Federal Reserve, ING

In the press conference, he will likely acknowledge that economic conditions do not justify rate cuts at this time. Nonetheless, he could reiterate his view that, in time, tech investment will boost US productivity, meaning faster growth without generating inflation. That would imply a lower neutral interest rate that justifies lower policy rates over the medium to longer term. He has also argued that the Fed's balance sheet is too large. He would like to shrink it relative to the size of the economy, which would be a de-facto tightening that can be offset by lower

policy rates.

Chair Warsh will also be questioned on updated Fed forecasts, which we expect to point to expectations of healthy growth and elevated inflation this year, with stable policy rates. But within the dot plot there may be more officials signalling that they think rates will be higher by the end of the year than there are those who think rates will be lower. However, Warsh has already suggested that the Fed talks too much and isn't a fan of forward guidance, so he will be keen to highlight that there are, in fact, two-sided risks and much can change between now and the end of the year.

An extended pause is our call

It is a very close call whether the Fed will hike rates this year, but on balance, we think it will instead choose to look through a near-term energy spike and hold rates steady for an extended period. The low-hire, low-fire economy means weak wage growth, with real household disposable income having fallen for three consecutive months. Consequently, elevated energy costs risk demand destruction that should help to dampen core inflation in time. Consumer and market inflation expectations remain in tolerable ranges and slowing housing rents, weak wage growth, a waning influence from tariffs and eventual energy price falls mean that inflation could undershoot the target in the second half of 2027. This environment should give the Fed room to resume moving policy rates back to neutral next year.

Now's the chance for Chair Warsh to walk the talk on balance sheet reduction

This is one meeting where the focus could well be on balance sheet and liquidity management. Kevin Warsh came into the job in the wake of various suggestions that the Fed should reduce the size of its balance sheet. We covered the issue [here](#), and noted that at the end of 2005, the Fed's balance sheet was about 5.5% of GDP. Roll on 20 years, in and out of the global financial crisis and pandemic, and it's now 21% of GDP (quadruple). The driver was bond buying. Total bonds held by the Fed were around 5.5% of GDP 20 years ago. That now equates to 20% of GDP (almost quadruple). Bank reserves were purely regulatory in nature and a puny 0.1% of GDP 20 years ago. Today's bank reserves are closer to 10% of GDP (100-fold).

Kevin Warsh wants to 'fix it', it seems. The technicalities could require the sale of all mortgage-backed bonds (US\$2tr) and at least half of the Treasury bonds (c.US\$2.5tr). So that's some US\$4.5tr in total, and would bring Fed bond holdings back down to around 5.5% of GDP (pre-GFC proportions). That in itself is big, and raises questions about a doable pace. On the other side of the balance sheet there is the complication of transitioning from the current excess bank reserves environment back potentially towards a scarce regulatory bank reserves environment. On the former, a Congress-legislated special purpose vehicle tasked with taking

the bonds off the Fed's balance sheet has been mooted (so they would not be "sold"). On the latter, an easing in bank liquidity ratios would be required.

For now, it's all quite speculative. But what we do know is Kevin Warsh can't simply sell bonds and stop there. He would need to address both sides of the balance sheet, and make regulatory changes to bank liquidity requirements. This is the kind of meeting from which we could well learn more about all of the above.

Dollar can hold gains

The FX market goes into this FOMC meeting in a mildly dollar-bullish frame of mind. In fact, it was the last FOMC meeting in late April and the dissent against the easing bias which laid the foundations for the dollar rally on better US data over the last six weeks.

A removal of the easing bias in Wednesday's statement is widely expected and, as usual, the market will probably react to the median expectation for the policy rate over coming years. This presumably could present some upside risks to the dollar.

When it comes to the press conference, it is probably too early to expect Chair Warsh to push back against market expectations of Fed tightening. After all, the economy and asset markets are already performing well in the face of this energy shock.

Our FX bias would be for the dollar to stay bid against the relative low yielders and whose central banks are trying to look through the inflation shock. Depending on what is happening to energy prices and the risk environment, pairs like USD/CAD and USD/SEK could stay bid, while GBP/USD could stay offered. EUR/USD may well press 1.15 again, but the prospect of another European Central Bank rate hike in July should provide some insulation.

Wednesday's FOMC will come a day after the Bank of Japan meeting. A BoJ rate hike to 1.00% is widely expected, but deeply negative Japanese real rates leave the yen vulnerable. A slightly hawkish FOMC meeting could send USD/JPY well above 160 again and elicit more intervention. Japanese authorities are well aware, however, that intervention is just a containment exercise until energy prices come a lot lower, markets start to think about Fed easing again, and Japanese real rates are much closer to neutral. That looks like a story for the end of this year at the earliest.

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Article | 11 June 2026

Lagarde keeps the door open for further ECB rate hikes

European Central Bank President Christine Lagarde's comments at the press conference kept the door to further rate hikes open



ECB President Christine Lagarde at today's press conference in Frankfurt, Germany. A second rate hike after today's decision now appears more likely

The ECB has done it. Today, it became the first major central bank to increase interest rates as part of the fight against stagflationary pressures triggered by the war in the Middle East. It opted for a 25bp hike, bringing the deposit interest rate to 2.25%.

To be clear, this rate hike is more of a symbolic move to signal the ECB's willingness and determination to avoid being too late in carrying out its policy response. It's not a rate hike that will derail the eurozone economy, but a decision made with clear communication and reputation in mind; the risk of doing nothing and potentially falling behind the curve is larger than the risk of any adverse effects on growth from higher interest rates, as suggested by Chief Economist Philip Lane in a recent speech.

More stagflationary pressures in staff projections but no reason for aggressive hikes

During the press conference, ECB President Christine Lagarde mentioned the broadening of inflationary pressures and indirect effects as the main reason for today's rate hike. Still, we can't shake the idea that the ECB is actually fighting ghosts from the past – more

specifically, its reaction that came far too late in responding to the inflation shock in 2021 and 2022. Remember that, at the time, the central bank lingered too long on the idea that an inflation surge driven by supply shocks was 'transitory' and could be looked through. If not for the experience of 2022, "transitory" could well be the label used today. So far, the increase in headline inflation has remained moderate. And while the knock-on effects of higher energy prices on other prices (e.g., transportation and food) will be hard to avoid, the latest survey-based inflation expectations have actually come down slightly.

This relatively well-behaved inflation trajectory is also reflected in the ECB's latest staff projections. Headline inflation is expected to come in at 3.0% this year, 2.3% in 2027 and 2.0% in 2028, slightly up from the March projections. Similar to our own forecasts, ECB staff expect inflation to drop below 2% in the second half of 2027. The GDP growth forecasts come in at 0.8% in 2026, 1.2% in 2027 and 1.5% in 2028, slightly down for 2026 and 2027 compared with the March projections. However, these growth forecasts have not incorporated the recent downward revision of first-quarter growth, meaning that the risk to this growth outlook is even more tilted to the downside than the ECB currently thinks. Overall, this is not a forecast that immediately calls for aggressive rate hikes.

Were there any other signals during the press conference?

During the press conference, Lagarde refuted the phrase 'insurance rate hike', claiming that today's move was nothing of the sort. She did so with almost the same verve with which she rejected the idea of 'stagflationary pressures' as well as the comparisons with 2022 at the April ECB meeting. On a more positive note, it seems as though someone, at least, follows our research. In all seriousness, the comment on the insurance rate hike suggests that today's decision was not a 'one and done' hike but rather a shift of the ECB's starting position.

The warning that inflationary pressures were broadening, as well as the emphasis on broadening indirect effects from higher energy prices, suggest that today's rate hike is not yet the end. However, at the risk of ending up on a blacklist at the ECB, what remains strange is the repetition of data dependency and a meeting-by-meeting approach in the context of the ECB's seemingly clear reaction function. Lagarde's comments on the different macro scenarios added to the confusion, with the ECB President at one point even mentioning rate cuts. Maybe the best description of the central bank's reaction function is what Lagarde herself mentioned during the press conference: "It will be what it will be."

All of this means that a second rate hike after today's decision, either in July or September, has become more likely. Still, as long as the bond market is taking over the ECB's work to tighten the monetary policy stance, governments don't fuel an inflationary spiral with fiscal stimulus, and sentiment indicators remain weak, it's hard to imagine that the ECB would really want to fight an exogenous supply shock with aggressive rate hikes at the cost of potentially worsening an economic downturn.

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Article | 15 June 2026

RATES SPARK

Rates Spark: The damage has been done

A slide lower in oil prices has helped rates dip, but we're not returning to pre-war yield levels. The US 10yr real yield is likely to remain elevated, and US inflation breakevens have little room to fall further. The ECB has already hiked once, and at least another hike is discounted. We anticipate more oil price volatility as a big reserve rebuild kicks off



Lower oil prices help, but we still expect bond yields to remain elevated due to inflation

Treasury yields to remain sticky to the upside, as real yields remain elevated

The Iran deal gets signed physically on Friday. But already apparently 'electronically signed'. The proof will come from the Strait, and the beginnings of a reopening is all markets care about. President Trump has promised this from Friday onwards. Reaction so far on the rates market has been predictably muted. Well before this deal, breakeven inflation rates had been falling. They are now back to where they were before the war started, which is quite remarkable (US 10yr breakeven at 2.3%; a perfect score).

US real yields are structurally higher by some 40bp since before the war, which, again, is quite remarkable. We doubt they collapse lower, which is why the 10yr yield will remain elevated. It's down post the deal announcement, but not by much. The 10yr yield is holding in the 4.45% area, where it has tended to hover in recent weeks. The 10yr real yield is just above 2%, which is broadly a neutral valuation, one that we saw before the GFC / pandemic impacted years. Barring a recession, it can hold in this area.

We broadly move on now. The US/Iran discussions continue. The Strait eases up. And the market discount for structurally negative inflation repercussions continues to ease. But note, we still have elevated inflation prints to deal with, as inflation is already elevated. And there is another month or so of follow-through to come on this. It makes it tough to get overly bullish on bonds, at least not given what we know.

Don't expect rates to return to when everything started

Brent prices have now dropped from close to US\$100/bbl down to almost US\$80/bbl in the span of less than two weeks. However, over the same time span, the market has already come to the conclusion that much of the damage has been done, and the overall reaction function of rates to the geopolitically driven oil prices has already settled at a higher level.

That means, while oil is at its lowest point since early March, 10y EUR swap rates are still around 3%, a level that has marked a soft floor to the long end rate over the past few months. The European Central Bank has, of course, already created facts in the meantime by delivering a rate hike last week. More importantly, official commentary even after the news of the deal over the weekend continues to lean hawkish, citing first signs of second-round effects and this being no time for complacency. The market is proving very reluctant to set aside its expectations of a second ECB rate hike, which remains more than fully priced by the end of the year.

The market reaction has also been faster than realities on the ground, and it can be altered by the prospects of a deal. A more durable repricing requires safe, predictable and insured shipping through the Strait of Hormuz. And demand could likely to be higher than usual as depleted reserves need to be replenished. Re-escalation risks are reduced, but not off the table.

For longer EUR rates at least, we also think that this is also only part of the story. The US narrative of macro resilience and the hawkish repricing that went in hand with it will also have had spillover effects. After all, it has been US real rates that have driven the leg higher, all the while (market-)inflation expectations have remained at very tolerable levels. What hasn't gone up in the first place with energy prices is unlikely to offer much relief as the latter has now come down.

Tuesday's events and market views

Mostly second tier data on the agenda, likely to keep the focus on geopolitical developments. From Europe, we will have the outcomes from June's ZEW business survey. For Germany, consensus sees a slight improvement in the expectations component, but still stuck in negative territory. For US data we have the import price index. When excluding petroleum, import prices are expected to rise by some 0.5% month-on-month. Housing starts data from May is expected to show a slight cooling

from the previous month's figure.

In terms of ECB speakers, we have Chief Economist Lane and Sleijpen from the Dutch central bank.

In primary markets, Germany will auction 5y bonds (€5bn) while the UK auctions 10y gilts (£4.25bn). Later the US Treasury will auction 20y bonds (US\$13bn).

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Article | 15 June 2026

THE NETHERLANDS

Despite a softer economic outlook and rising costs, activity in the Netherlands remains resilient

Dutch businesses have become more pessimistic about the economic outlook as energy costs are elevated, yet short-term expectations for their own activity have held up relatively well. This divergence points to uncertainty, suggesting that economic growth will remain subdued in the quarters ahead



Even though Dutch businesses are pessimistic on the economic outlook, they are more confident on their own outlook

Some solid monthly data

The first hard data for second quarter 2026 suggest that it might not be such a bad quarter for GDP, with the possibility of stronger growth than in the first quarter. Goods export volumes growth accelerated to 4.4% year-on-year in April, while the expansion of goods imports dropped to 1.2% YoY. Manufacturing production rose by a considerable 1.3% month-on-month in April, mainly due to the continuing strong growth in machinery and a strong recovery in electronics. And the manufacturing PMI rose further to a level of 55, indicating decent growth for the rest of the quarter. Encouraging was the fact that the rise in PMI was

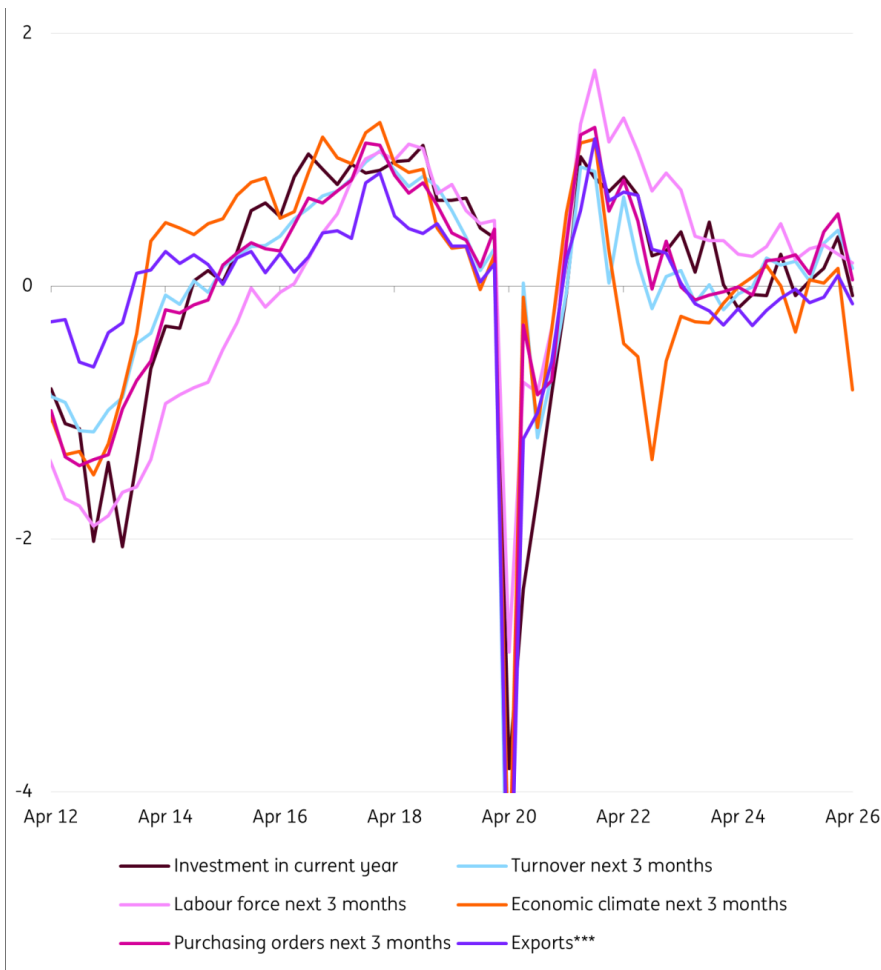
visible in almost all underlying indicators.

Divergence in own outlook vs. wider outlook

The quarterly business cycle survey among Dutch firms in the entire business economy by Statistics Netherlands and partners from April – the first survey since the start of the war in Iran – suggested considerably more pessimism about the economy at large. The survey also showed only a slight decline in firms' confidence in their own outlook. Most significant for the expectation of their own situation is a fall in purchasing orders. Turnover, employment, export and investment expectations have deteriorated only to a mild extent since the start of the Iran war and remain (albeit slightly) very close to their long-term averages. Firms' assessment of their competitive position even improved. Perhaps Asia suffers more from disrupted energy flows originating from the Gulf.

While Dutch businesses became much more pessimistic about the economic climate, the expectations of their own situation has deteriorated much less

Normalised indicator* for the development over the next three months (only for investments in the current year), according to businesses** based on a quarterly survey



Source: CBS, EIB, KvK, MKB Nederland and VNO-NCW, calc. ING Research; *Seasonally adjusted responses, weighted by business size, expressed as the percentage of positive minus negative responses, normalised to one standard deviation of the long-term average. Inclu

Investment neither plummeting nor buoyant

Although it was interesting to see that investment expectations of firms only fell a little, our forecast for capital expenditures was already at a subdued level. The expenditures are hindered by geopolitical tensions, structural constraints like nitrogen emission restrictions, electricity grid congestion, and increased competition (e.g. China).

Public (housing and defence) investment is rising though, while structural factors such as population ageing push healthcare spending higher, is helping to keep economic growth going. Planned austerity measures to accommodate higher defence spending won't take effect before 2027 and have so far received little support. Most notably, the proposed increase in the statutory pension age was rejected. That means that public spending remains a boost to GDP growth this year, albeit less so than in 2025, while uncertainty about the fiscal drag in 2027 remains.

Downbeat consumer not in lowest gear

Despite some looming tax increases that should finance higher defence spending next year, Dutch households' financial position on average remains decent so far, despite rising inflation. Wage growth is still high (4.2% YoY in May) and unemployment fell (3.9% in April), containing the risk of extreme precautionary behaviour. This might explain why consumption hasn't really collapsed, despite low consumer confidence and higher inflation. Domestic consumption volumes were still 1% up YoY in April, from 0.9% in March. Nevertheless, we expect the savings rate to remain high going forward, as real income developments deteriorate amidst a low-confidence environment.

Unchanged outlook with risks remaining

All in all, it still looks like Dutch GDP growth could be higher in 2Q26 than in 1Q26. We had that already pencilled into our forecast. So, the Dutch economy still seems to continue to grow at a below-normal pace in the current and upcoming quarter, leading to a mediocre 1.0% GDP growth in 2026 after a solid 1.8% in 2025. With low consumer confidence, uncertainty about the situation in the Gulf region and lower (price) momentum in the housing market, risks to the outlook remain, but currently, there are still no clear signs of a serious recession in the Netherlands.

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Article | 15 June 2026

POLAND

Poland confirms unexpected decline in May inflation

Excess supply across many food categories has outweighed the energy shock. Core inflation edged up, but came in below expectations; for now, the energy shock is having only a limited impact on prices. Inflation rose in expected categories such as air fares and tourism, while prices of other goods are falling due to demand constraints and imports from China



Food prices are currently being held down by high inventories, but weather conditions and rising fertiliser prices may lead to growth in the coming quarters

Excess of supply across many food categories outweighed the energy shock

Statistics Poland has confirmed the preliminary estimate of May's inflation reading at 3.1% year-on-year and 0.6% month-on-month. The slight decline in annual inflation relative to April (3.2% YoY) was driven mainly by food and non-alcoholic beverage prices, whose monthly dynamics were surprisingly low by historical standards for May (0.5% YoY and -1.0% MoM). In annual terms, prices fell for cooking oil and related fats (-16.7% YoY), meat (-4.5%), cereal (-3.0%) and vegetables (-2.2%), while dairy price growth remained relatively subdued (0.6%).

Against this backdrop, fruit prices stood out with a strong annual growth of 5.0%. While food prices are currently being held down by high inventories, weather conditions and rising prices of fertilisers may lead to faster food price growth in the coming quarters. Energy carrier prices were unchanged relative to April, although their annual growth rate was at 4.9% – slightly below the preliminary figure reported two weeks ago (5.0% YoY). Statistics Poland also confirmed the estimates for fuel price growth (12.3% YoY and -0.1% MoM).

Polish government to withdraw from the Lower Fuel Prices programme

Today's data indicates that core inflation rose from 3.0% in April to 3.1% in May. The energy shock is feeding through into core goods and services, but its impact remains limited. Inflation increased for air fares (to 10.2% YoY), as well as for foreign travel (8.9%) and domestic accommodation (3.8%). At the same time, prices of many goods are falling, from clothing to numerous other items, such as the recreation and culture category and household equipment. In our view, demand constraints are at play: the large price increases of previous years pushed prices to such high levels that they are now meeting resistance from sluggish real income growth. The disinflationary impact of imports from China is also still visible.

The increase in consumer inflation following the outbreak of war in Iran was slowed by the introduction of the Lower Fuel Prices (CPN) package. European Commission data shows that fuel prices in Poland were significantly below those in other EU countries; on 11 June, the price per litre in Poland was €1.40 for petrol (E95) and €1.49 for diesel, compared with EU averages of €1.82 and €1.83, respectively.

Weekend reports suggest that the CPN package will be withdrawn in two stages: fuel excise duty will be raised from 16 June, and the 23% VAT rate will be reinstated from 1 July. The impact of these changes on CPI inflation will be somewhat counterbalanced by declines in crude oil prices on international markets (today, Brent crude is trading at around US\$83/bbl), and this is already reflected in our forecasts. These forecasts indicate that CPI inflation in the coming months will remain slightly above 3% YoY, and therefore still within the permissible deviation from the National Bank of Poland's target.

We expect interest rates to stay on hold in 2026

Financial markets are still pricing in a rate hike in Poland, but the Monetary Policy Council is increasingly signalling that it sees the war as a supply-side shock that should be looked through. That is also our view. We assume interest rates will remain unchanged until the end of this year.

The near-agreement between the US and Iran announced over the weekend does not materially change our inflation forecasts, as we believe that the reopening of the Strait of Hormuz would lead only to a limited fall in oil prices, which we had already assumed. The

reasons for the muted oil price response to an agreement are widely acknowledged: a) the fragility of the peace, b) uncertainty over the pace at which commodity transport can be restored, c) the time needed to repair war damage to infrastructure, and d) the need to rebuild inventories. Global oil inventories for May and June are not yet available, but figures up to April suggested that by July, global reserves would be low enough that many countries would decide to rebuild stocks rapidly, implying a surge in demand that would prevent a fall in crude prices.

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Article | 15 June 2026

FX TALKING NORWAY SWEDEN

G10 FX Talking: Dollar stronger for longer

Despite all the talk of de-dollarisation last year, there's been no follow-through selling. Importantly, investors now think the Federal Reserve will be in a position to tighten policy rates as the labour market stabilises and inflation moves further away from the Fed's 2% target. We think the dollar can hold recent gains this summer



Dollar dominance: supported by higher-for-longer US rates and renewed confidence in Fed tightening

Main ING G10 FX Forecasts

	EUR/USD		USD/JPY		GBP/USD	
1M	1.15	↓	160	→	1.32	↓
3M	1.15	↓	160	↑	1.31	↓
6M	1.17	→	158	→	1.33	↓
12M	1.20	↑	154	↓	1.35	↑

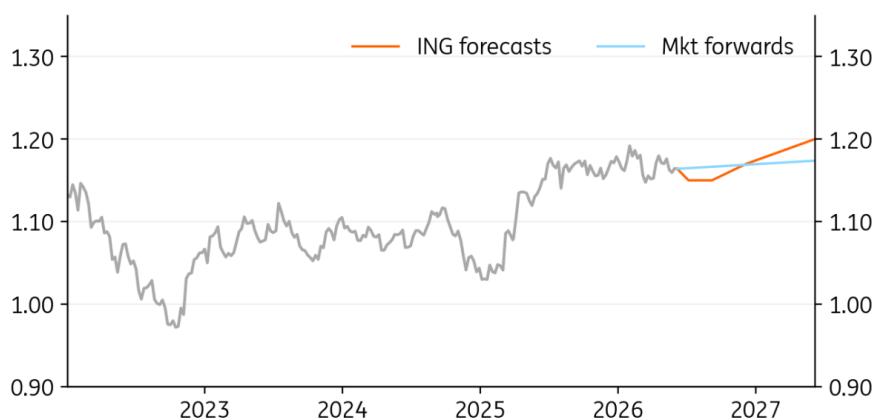
EUR/GBP		EUR/CHF		USD/CAD	
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1M	0.87	↑	0.92	→	1.40	→
3M	0.88	↑	0.92	→	1.39	→
6M	0.88	↑	0.92	↑	1.37	↓
12M	0.89	↑	0.92	↑	1.33	↓

EUR/USD: Riding out Fed hawkishness

	Spot	One month bias	1M	3M	6M	12M
EUR/USD	1.1600	Mildly Bearish ↘	1.15	1.15	1.17	1.20

- It looks like FX markets are entering a period where the dollar will be back in demand. Our house call is that energy prices will remain high or rise further into July as inventory drawdown strategies are questioned. This inflation shock will be with us for longer. With a stable labour market, the Federal Reserve will have to delay its easing cycle deep into 2027. Bearish flattening of the yield curve means cyclical dollar strength should be with us through the summer.
- Having already hiked to 2.25%, we expect another hike from the European Central Bank either in July or September. But the stagflationary shock will be felt more in the eurozone than in the US.
- EUR/USD could be pushed to 1.13/14 in July – but this is not 2022.

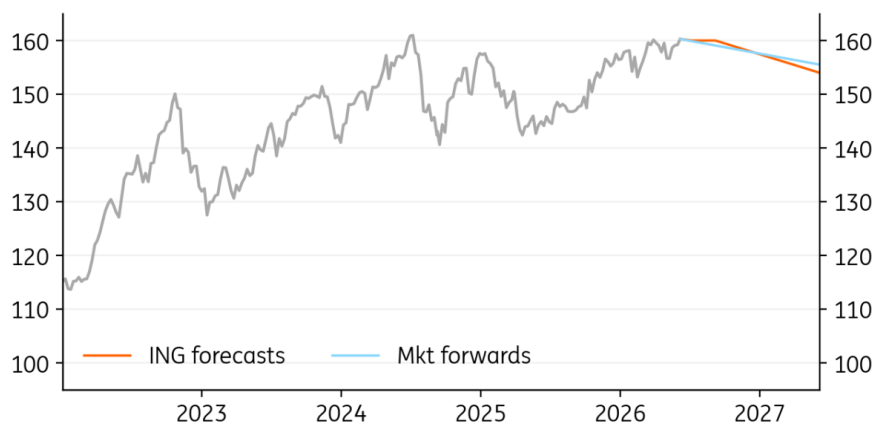


Source: Refinitiv, ING Forecasts

USD/JPY: Decreasing marginal returns of intervention

	Spot	One month bias	1M	3M	6M	12M
USD/JPY	160.10	Neutral	160.00	160.00	158.00	154.00

- The \$70bn of FX sales undertaken by the Bank of Japan in late April/early May only bought Tokyo a little time. Japanese authorities appreciate that the dollar is bid, yen real rates are deeply negative, and the speculative market is not especially short yen.
- There's also the issue that too frequent interventions (more than three times over a six-month period) could see Japan lose its 'freely floating' IMF currency regime designation.
- All this points to USD/JPY staying bid this summer and potentially advancing into the 162/163 area. What would be a game-changer, albeit unlikely, is the US Treasury engaging in joint intervention. The Fed did check USD/JPY rates in January.

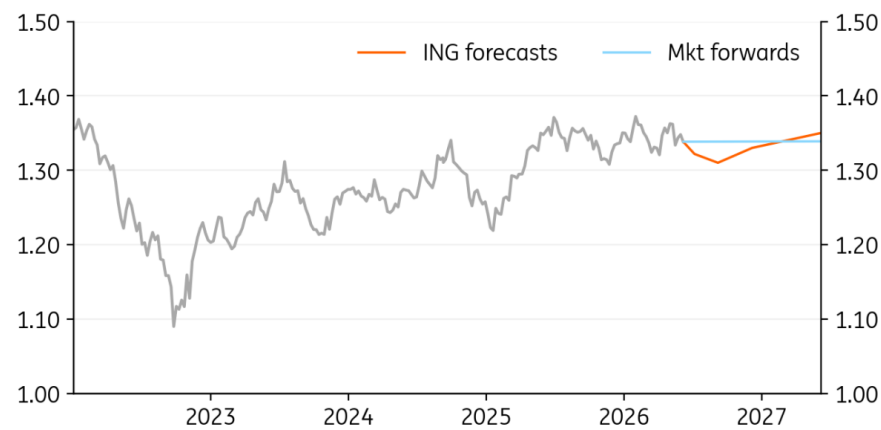


Source: Refinitiv, ING Forecasts

GBP/USD: Sluggish BoE, UK politics to weigh

	Spot	One month bias	1M	3M	6M	12M
	1.3400	Mildly Bearish ↘	1.32	1.31	1.33	1.35

- Our team has recently revised the Bank of England call to look for one 25bp hike in July (to 4.00%) and then three cuts from 2Q27 onwards. One hike will probably not be enough to deliver strong support for the pound in what should be a strong-dollar environment this summer.
- Look out for politics to heat up around 18 June, when PM Keir Starmer’s rival, Andy Burnham, looks set to win a by-election. Victory would see him formally challenge Starmer. Burnham becoming PM would mark a clear shift to the left in UK politics.
- That said, GBP has been proving resilient this year. Cheap valuations and £200bn of UK-targeted M&A could be factors.

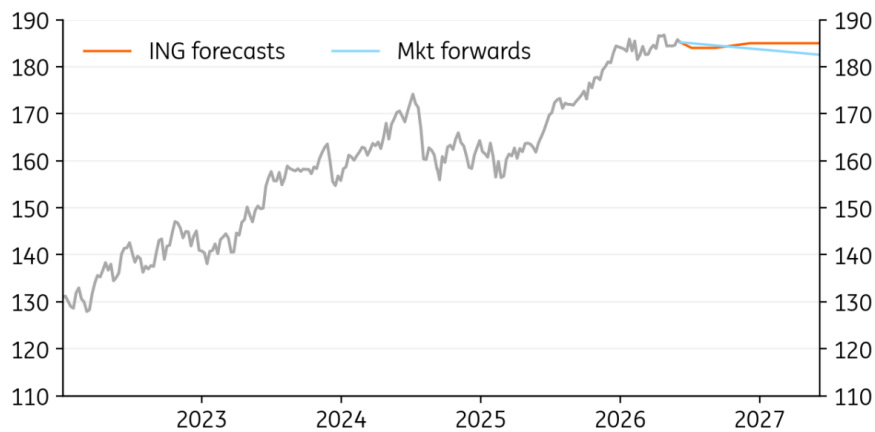


Source: Refinitiv, ING Forecasts

EUR/JPY: Slight downside bias emerging

	Spot	One month bias	1M	3M	6M	12M
EUR/JPY	185.3800	Mildly Bearish ↘	184.00	184.00	185.00	185.00

- EUR/JPY has been remarkably stable, near 185, over recent months. If we are right with a big spike in energy over the next four to six weeks, both the euro and the yen should come under pressure. But we see more downside for EUR/USD than upside for USD/JPY. This is because the Japanese will probably try to intervene again in the 161/162 region.
- Domestically, the Bank of Japan may well hike at the 16 June meeting and the market is pricing close to a second hike by December. Investors will be focused on the friction between the BoJ and the government. Any pressure against rate hikes could hit the yen.
- A big tech sell-off is one of the downside risks to EUR/JPY.

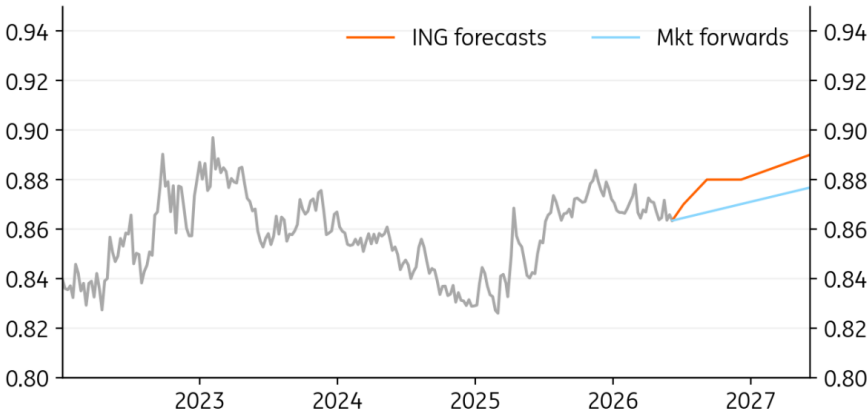


Source: Refinitiv, ING Forecasts

EUR/GBP: Exceptionally low volatility

	Spot	One month bias	1M	3M	6M	12M
EUR/GBP	0.8600	Mildly Bullish 	0.87	0.88	0.88	0.89

- EUR/GBP volatility (both traded and realised) remains exceptionally low. There is a slight kink in the volatility curve around the one- to two-week term, which probably reflects the unrest surrounding the Makerfield by-election on 18 June.
- From what we can see, strong EUR/GBP support should hold around the 0.8600/8610 area, and we favour a bounce back to 0.87 on the view that Andy Burnham will oust PM Starmer and that the BoE will lag ECB tightening this summer.
- The near-term risk is that we see a repeat of March's price action. A spike in energy saw the market price more BoE than ECB rate hikes and EUR/GBP came under pressure.

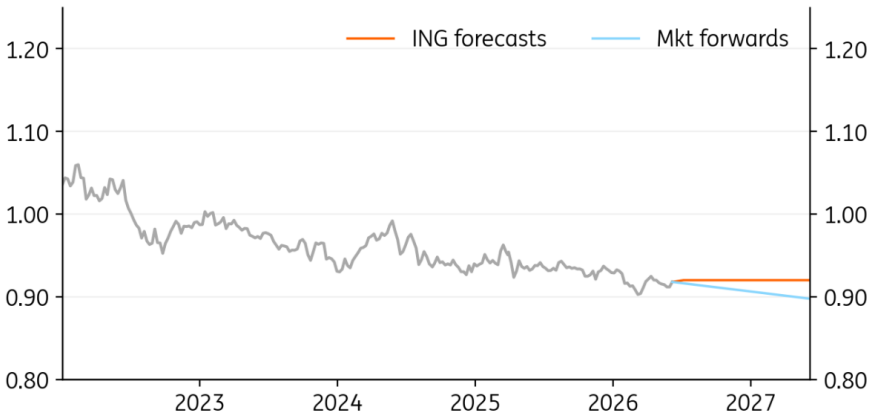


Source: Refinitiv, ING Forecasts

EUR/CHF: Unwind of the dollar debasement hurts CHF

	Spot	One month bias	1M	3M	6M	12M
EUR/CHF	0.9200	Neutral	0.92	0.92	0.92	0.92

- The shift in market pricing towards Fed tightening has weighed on the Swiss franc through two channels. The first is the unwinding of the dollar debasement trade. This has seen the franc, gold and bitcoin all come under pressure on the view that the Fed is not ‘captured’ after all and could end up hiking.
- The second channel is through more conventional rate spreads, where the ECB is tightening and the Swiss National Bank will lag. Two-year EUR:CHF swap differentials have widened to 270bp. However, it’s not clear how much further widening can be expected.
- SNB FX intervention data on 30 June should show the largest FX buying since 2020/21 and keep EUR/CHF downside limited.

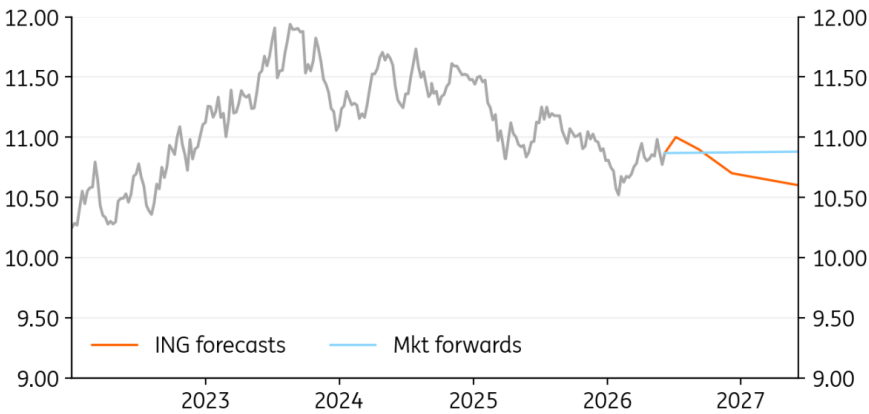


Source: Refinitiv, ING Forecasts

EUR/SEK: Riksbank hike hinges on the krona

	Spot	One month bias	1M	3M	6M	12M
EUR/SEK	10.9300	Mildly Bullish 	11.00	10.90	10.70	10.60

- We are revising our EUR/SEK profile moderately higher, in line with a more bullish view on oil and a call for two ECB hikes.
- We still think markets are overestimating the chance of a Riksbank hike. Inflation is still below target, and the pass-through from higher oil prices is smaller and slower in Sweden than in the eurozone.
- Still, the risks of a hike have increased somewhat. In our view, a realistic trigger could be a sharp weakening of the krona. The Riksbank might try to contain it by hiking rates to avoid spillover into inflation expectations. That may not happen until EUR/SEK hits 11.10-11.15, which is not our current base case.

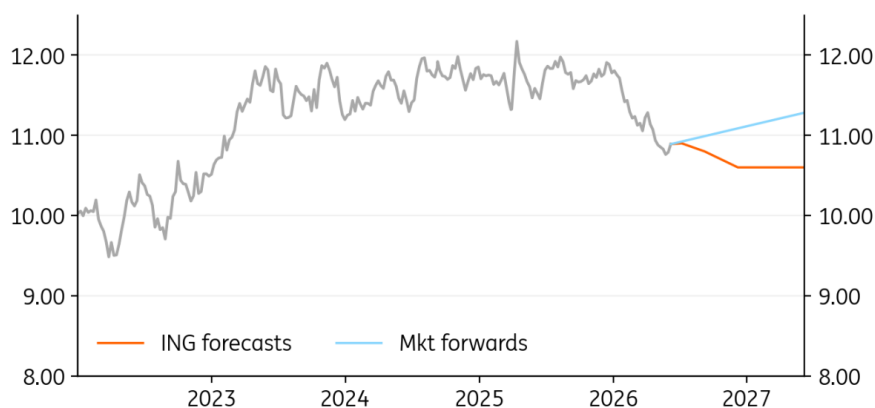


Source: Refinitiv, ING Forecasts

EUR/NOK: Ready to benefit from new oil rallies

	Spot	One month bias	1M	3M	6M	12M
EUR/NOK	11.0500	Mildly Bearish 	10.90	10.80	10.60	10.60

- We are pencilling in another Norges Bank 25bp hike this year, contingent on an increase in oil prices this summer. That would further enhance the krone's already attractive carry, though the currency will likely need a broader stabilisation in global risk before those advantages can fully register. A Brent price above \$110/bbl, as forecast by our commodities team, should drive EUR/NOK lower, net of any short-lived corrections in risk sentiment.
- The main risks for NOK in this scenario are related to bigger equity corrections and/or the Fed hiking more than once.

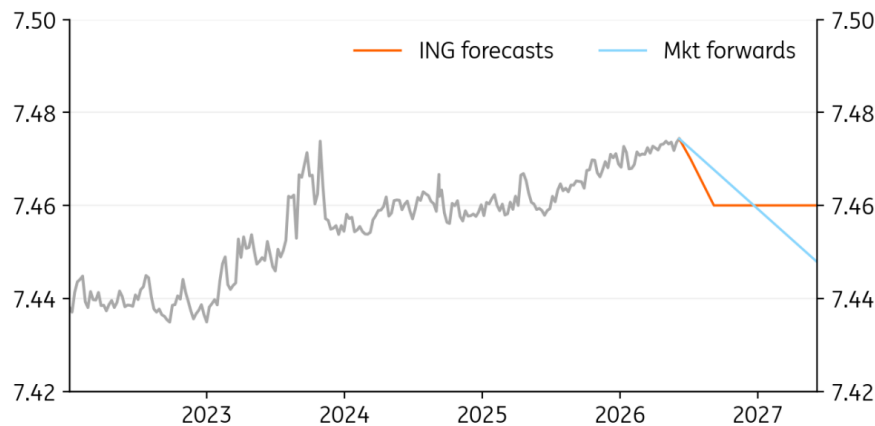


Source: Refinitiv, ING Forecasts

EUR/DKK: Still tolerated at these high levels

	Spot	One month bias	1M	3M	6M	12M
EUR/DKK	7.4700	Neutral	7.47	7.46	7.46	7.46

- The Danish central bank continues to show tolerance for the relatively strong EUR/DKK, choosing not to intervene to buy DKK again in May and hiking 25bp like the ECB on 11 June.
- We still think we are close to a tipping point in EUR/DKK strength to trigger new FX intervention or action on the rates side to close the policy gap with the ECB.
- Our view, therefore, remains that EUR/DKK will stay close to the 7.470 mark in the second half of the year.

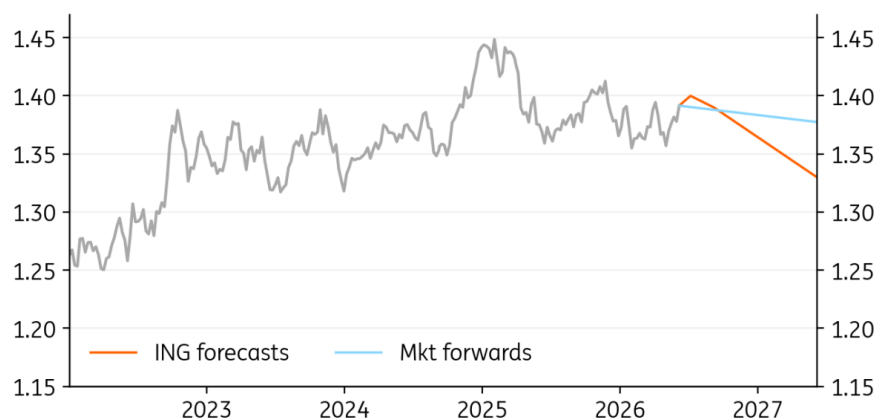


Source: Refinitiv, ING Forecasts

USD/CAD: CAD in an undesirable spot near term

	Spot	One month bias	1M	3M	6M	12M
USD/CAD	1.4000	Neutral	1.40	1.39	1.37	1.33

- Idiosyncratic risks have continued to weigh on Canada's dollar. The labour market rebounded in May, but the April jobs slump, paired with a technical recession, has left Bank of Canada officials a bit more cautious on tightening. We don't expect a hike.
- USMCA renegotiations may well be the next big thing on President Trump's agenda. It's still unclear how those will be dealt with alongside Iran negotiations and the World Cup. But trade tensions remain an important driver of uncertainty for Canadian businesses.
- Higher oil prices can partly offset those domestic woes for CAD in the crosses, but not in USD/CAD. We now expect it to break above 1.40 before gradually easing back towards 1.37 in the second half of 2026.

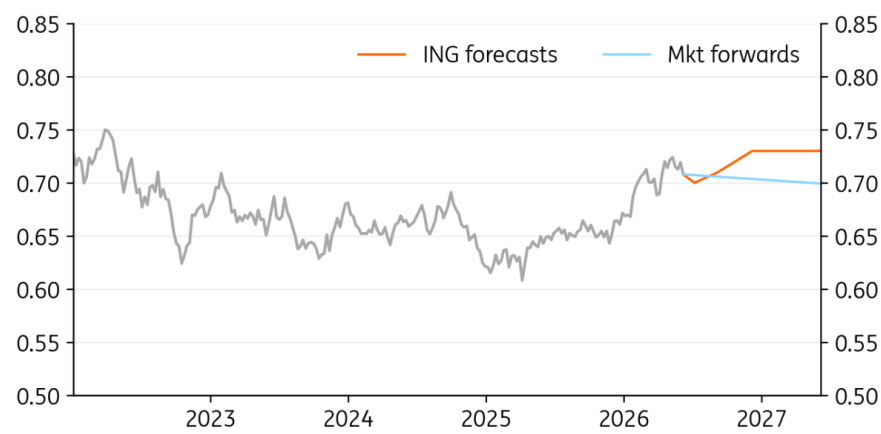


Source: Refinitiv, ING Forecasts

AUD/USD: More short-term turbulence possible

	Spot	One month bias	1M	3M	6M	12M
AUD/USD	0.7000	Neutral	0.70	0.71	0.73	0.73

- The likelihood of another rate hike by the Reserve Bank of Australia would rise, especially in a potentially rocky summer for energy markets. The Bank might have a slightly higher bar to tighten again, but it has shown little hesitation to act if data heats up.
- The positive impact on AUD/USD from another RBA hike would, however, be more than offset by potential Fed tightening, which tends to have a deeper impact on high-beta currencies than domestic stories.
- Beyond a potentially turbulent summer, we remain optimistic on AUD's outlook. Carry and terms-of-trade improvements are pointing higher. If risk sentiment holds, AUD should emerge as an outperformer again later this year.

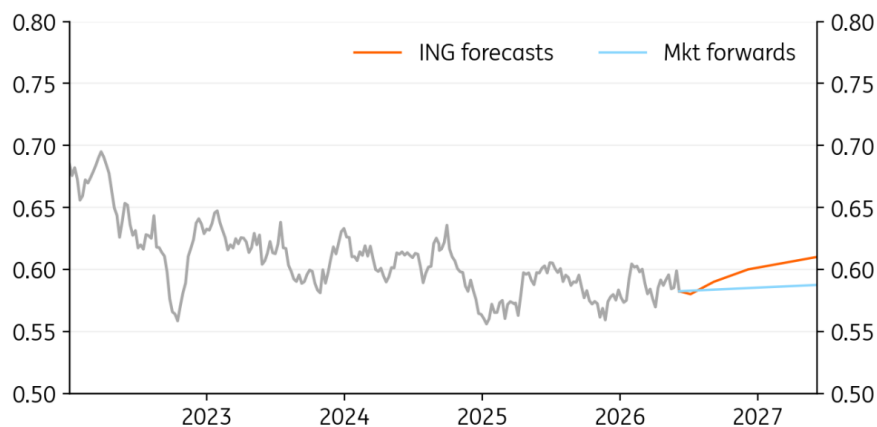


Source: Refinitiv, ING Forecasts

NZD/USD: Hikes fully priced in

	Spot	One month bias	1M	3M	6M	12M
NZD/USD	0.5800	Neutral	0.58	0.59	0.60	0.61

- The Reserve Bank of New Zealand should start hiking rates on 8 July after a strongly dissented hold in May. If oil prices spike over the next few weeks, we see a chance of a 50 bp increase in July.
- Even if the hike is only 25bp, the messaging may well need to remain hawkish to avoid a rates repricing that could push inflation expectations higher. Markets are pricing in 75bp of RBNZ hikes by year-end; our call is 50bp, with hawkish risks. Still, we expect the Fed story to be a bigger driver for NZD/USD.
- We are still looking at some upside for the pair in 2H26, but we expect AUD to outpace NZD again into year-end.



Source: Refinitiv, ING Forecasts

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Article | 15 June 2026

FX TALKING CZECH REPUBLIC HUNGARY

EMEA FX Talking: Hungarian love affair continues

Investors love affair with Hungarian assets continues as the new government talks of euro adoption. Expect the forint to hold gains even though the central bank will be cutting the policy rate. Also staying bid, but on the back of a hawkish central bank, will be the Czech koruna. The Polish zloty should lag, given our view of unchanged policy rates this year



Strong forint and koruna outperform as the zloty trails

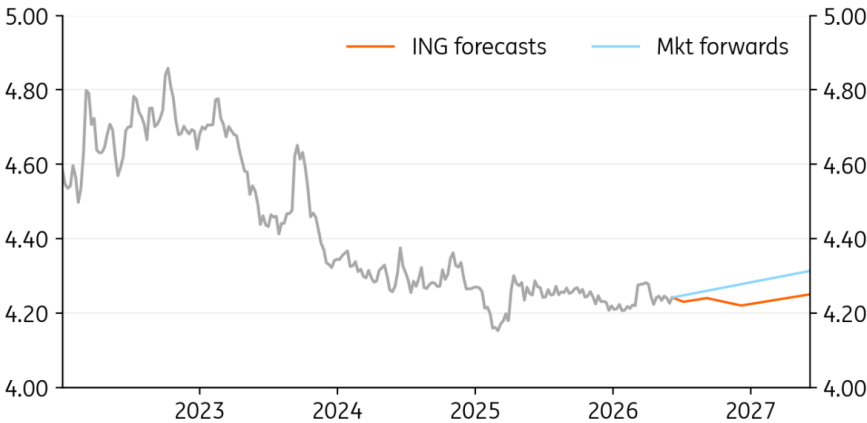
Main ING EMEA FX Forecasts

	EUR/CZK		EUR/PLN		EUR/HUF	
1M	24.20	↑	4.23	↑	350	↓
3M	24.15	↓	4.24	↑	360	↑
6M	24.10	↓	4.22	↑	355	↓
12M	24.00	↓	4.25	↑	360	↓

EUR/PLN: Zloty remains stable

	Spot	One month bias	1M	3M	6M	12M
EUR/PLN	4.2500	Mildly Bearish ↘	4.23	4.24	4.22	4.25

- EUR/PLN maintains its narrow range (4.23 – 4.26) despite the turmoil in the Gulf, US dollar strength and a less hawkish approach by the central bank governor in June. The zloty remains relatively resilient to these factors.
- July was perceived as a live Monetary Policy Council meeting (due to the new projections), but recent dovish MPC comments and a low May CPI support our no-hike view for 2026, while markets still price 75bp in hikes. These expectations shield the zloty against risk-off waves.
- Our view on the zloty remains unchanged. We expect a limited rise in EUR/USD in the second half of 2026, sustainable GDP outperformance and expected inflows of EU funds to justify EUR/PLN hovering close to 4.24. Risks are still linked to geopolitical factors and a dovish MPC.

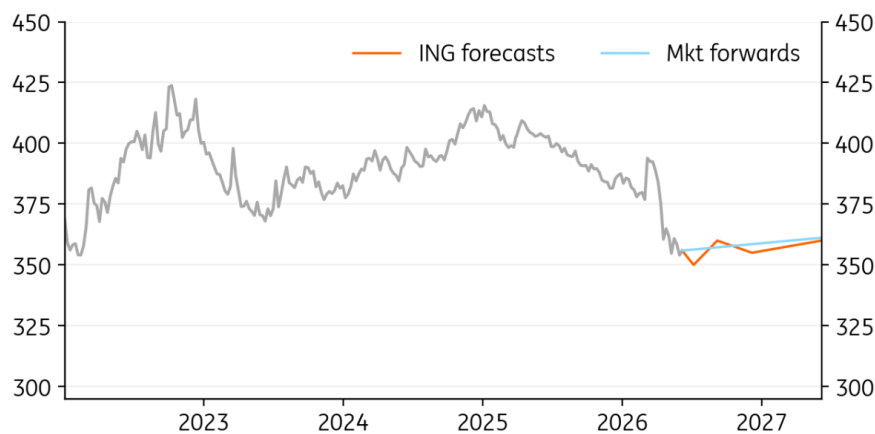


Source: Refinitiv, ING Forecasts

EUR/HUF: Positive factors to maintain the strength of the HUF

	Spot	One month bias	1M	3M	6M	12M
EUR/HUF	352.9100	Mildly Bearish 	350.00	360.00	355.00	360.00

- We see the National Bank of Hungary cutting the base rate on 23 June. The extremely favourable May inflation print at 1.8% made us consider the possibility of a 50bp cut, though we still regard this as a remote option.
- With almost 100bp of easing priced in until end-2026, the easing cycle won't derail the forint's superstar status. Positive factors such as full access to EU funds, upgrades to ratings outlooks and a convergence programme should keep EUR/HUF at around 355 despite the lower interest rate premium.
- As policymakers prefer lower rates to a stronger forint, we see reactive policies sustaining a 350-360 range in the long term.

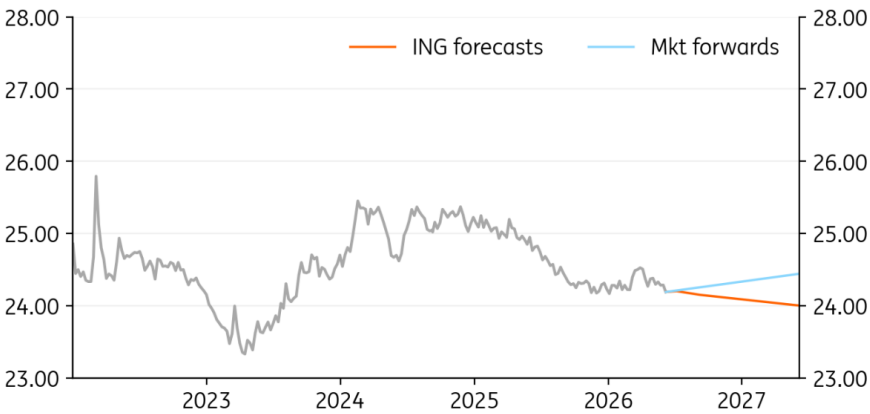


Source: Refinitiv, ING Forecasts

EUR/CZK: Czech rate hike on its way

	Spot	One month bias	1M	3M	6M	12M
EUR/CZK	24.1800	Neutral	24.20	24.15	24.10	24.00

- The Czech National Bank will likely proceed with one hike at its June meeting, which has been signalled by ample hawkish talk. However, we expect a split vote with a close call between a hike and flat base rate.
- In any case, the koruna will further be supported by the positive interest rate differential against the euro in both nominal and real terms. The recent ECB rate increase is not a substantial adjustment here.
- Should we see the impact of the Hormuz crisis on real growth in 2Q, the Czech and eurozone economies will both be affected. The economic support for the koruna should prevail and underscore its relative strength.

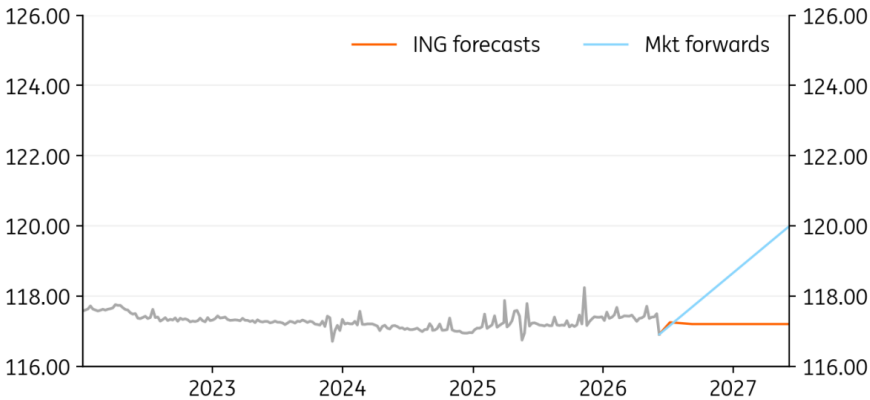


Source: Refinitiv, ING Forecasts

EUR/RSD: Investment trends keeping RSD supported

	Spot	One month bias	1M	3M	6M	12M
EUR/RSD	117.3600	Neutral	117.25	117.20	117.20	117.20

- EUR/RSD has continued to trade mostly sideways, despite persistent political tensions. However, more positively, the shareholders’ agreement for the sale of the NIS refinery has concluded, after months of uncertainty. The pair sat mostly between the 117.30 – 117.50 range. Preparations and last-mile investments related to the EXPO 2027 event are also beginning to gather pace.
- As such, investments are still set to continue to fuel the tailwinds in activity ahead, while the country’s external position remains in check. The still-high, double-digit wage growth acted as a cushion through most of the recent uncertainties and has allowed demand to remain robust.
- At its June meeting, the National Bank of Serbia kept the key rate in place at 5.75% - highlighting the short-run inflationary pressures expected. We continue to believe that FX stability should remain a key focus ahead – in January-April, the Bank sold EUR 1205mn to keep the pair stable.

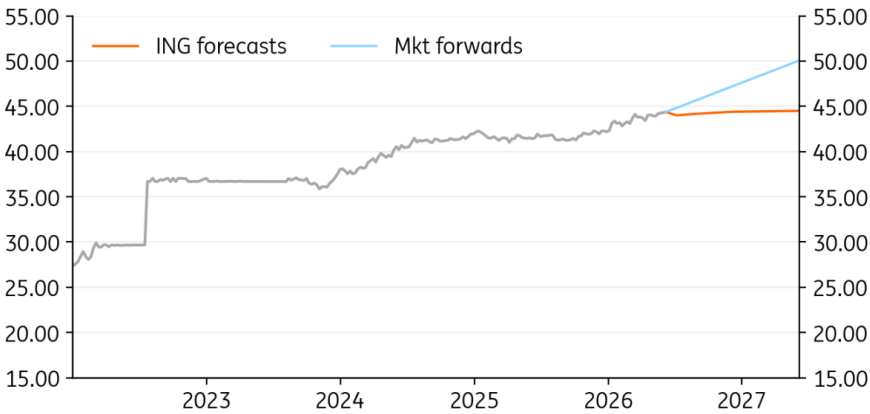


Source: Refinitiv, ING Forecasts

USD/UAH: Hryvnia at record low level

	Spot	One month bias	1M	3M	6M	12M
USD/UAH	44.8200	Mildly Bearish ↘	44.00	44.20	44.40	44.50

- As the US dollar strengthened on the back of solid data, USD/UAH rose towards 44.8, a record high level. The National Bank of Ukraine’s efforts to stabilise the hryvnia are insufficient to fully offset the global financial markets impact. Thus, the outlook for the hryvnia remains cloudy.
- May was another month in which international reserves of the NBU decreased (by 5.2% after 7.3% in April), mainly due to FX interventions and FX debt repayments. Nevertheless, the NBU see them as sufficient to maintain FX market stability.
- Still, the macroeconomic environment remains challenging due to the ongoing war. However, the latest business outlook survey shows further signs of an improvement with construction and industrial companies maintaining the most optimistic outlook.

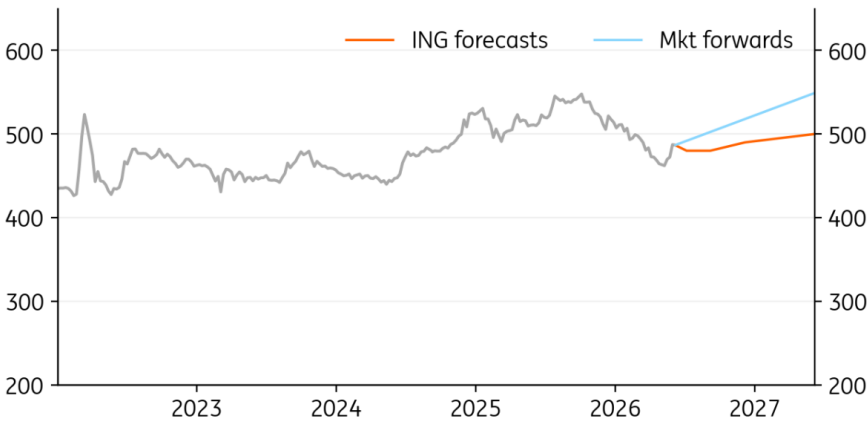


Source: Refinitiv, ING Forecasts

USD/KZT: Real rates remain high despite the surprise rate cut

	Spot	One month bias	1M	3M	6M	12M
	489.4300	Bearish 	480.00	480.00	490.00	500.00

- The tenge lost around 5% over the last month, following the correction in the oil prices. Meanwhile, [the updated house view](#) suggests upside.
- The National Bank of Kazakhstan made a surprise cut in the base rate by 100bp to 17.00%, without any commitment to further easing. With CPI of around 10% year-on-year, Kazakhstan’s real rates remain high.
- We expect the tenge to continue to benefit from portfolio capital inflows thanks to the future Euroclear connection, issuance plans, and hopes of an improved position in global bond indices. Meanwhile, the effect of higher oil prices should be muted by the accompanying dividend outflow.

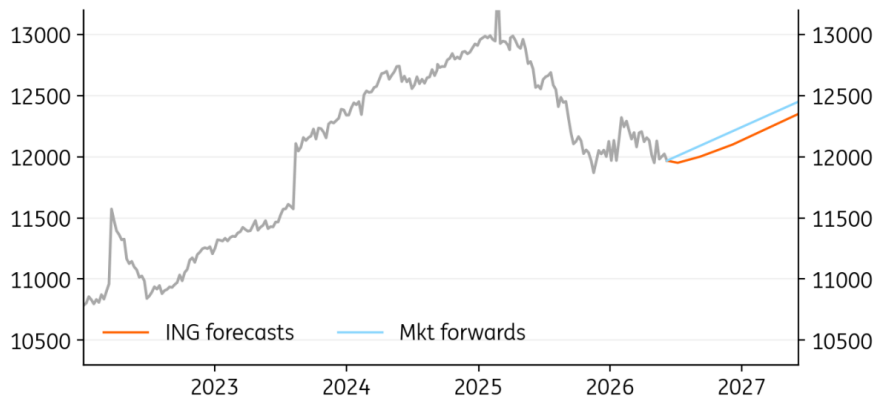


Source: Refinitiv, ING Forecasts

USD/UZS: Long-awaited restart of gold exports lifts UZS

Spot	One month bias	1M	3M	6M	12M
11,977.0000	Neutral	11950.00	12000.00	12100.00	12350.00

- The soum appreciated against the US dollar by around 1% over the last month, in line with our constructive view. The long-awaited [restart of the gold exports](#) was the main support factor.
- Portfolio inflows, likely supported by the privatisation pipeline and improved sovereign rating prospects should serve as additional reinforcement for the FX market
- A stronger soum combined with apparent ongoing fiscal consolidation have contributed to a material drop in CPI growth to 5.5% year-on-year as of May, creating room for a cut in the policy rate from the current high level of 14.00%.

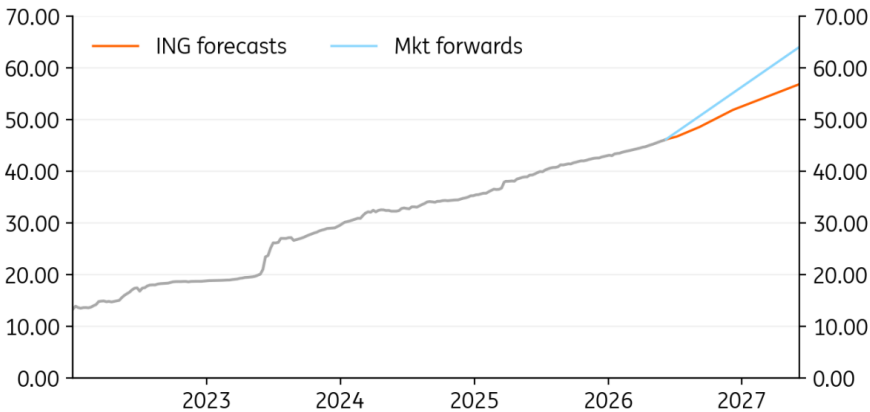


Source: Refinitiv, ING Forecasts

USD/TRY: A clear intention to preserve flexibility in policymaking

	Spot	One month bias	1M	3M	6M	12M
USD/TRY	46.2600	Mildly Bullish 	46.65	48.50	51.80	56.80

- May inflation has not yet shown a clear return to a disinflation trend, indicating a still challenging outlook. Uncertainty around oil prices, and the spillover into other commodities, continues to pose risks. Food inflation remains uncertain, shaped by agricultural supply expectations and potential fertiliser cost pressures. Annual inflation is expected slightly below 30%.
- The Middle East conflict has required a prolonged period of tight monetary policy, accompanied by stricter credit growth caps. These measures reflect a widening current account deficit and increased financial stability concerns after the court decision. Despite stable lending trends, the central bank has lowered TRY loan growth limits for the retail and corporate segments.
- Given this backdrop, all policy options continue to be available for the Central Bank of Turkey. This approach signals a clear intention to preserve flexibility in policymaking depending on changing geopolitical conditions. In the near term, we think the CBT will remain in a wait-and-see approach before deciding whether to reduce the effective cost of funding back toward the policy rate.

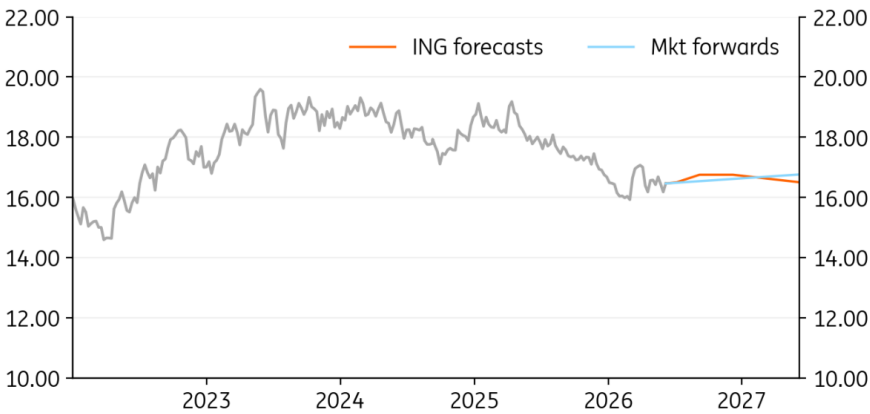


Source: Refinitiv, ING Forecasts

USD/ZAR: Headwinds growing, including El Nino

	Spot	One month bias	1M	3M	6M	12M
USD/ZAR	16.2600	Mildly Bullish 	16.50	16.75	16.75	16.50

- Higher US rates and a tech-led sell-off in risk assets have started to weigh on the rand. But last month, the South African Reserve Bank pre-emptively hiked to 7%, leaving the rand with real rate protection of nearly 3%. The SARB has presented a worst-case scenario for rate hikes if the Strait of Hormuz remains closed for longer and El Nino hits hard. This could see SARB hike to 7.75%.
- We are raising our USD/ZAR profile because of the Fed story but still see it lower through 2027 on high yields, strong commodity prices and eventually lower rates in the US.
- But a heavy El Nino this November-February, causing drought in Asia and Africa, could be a major rand negative.

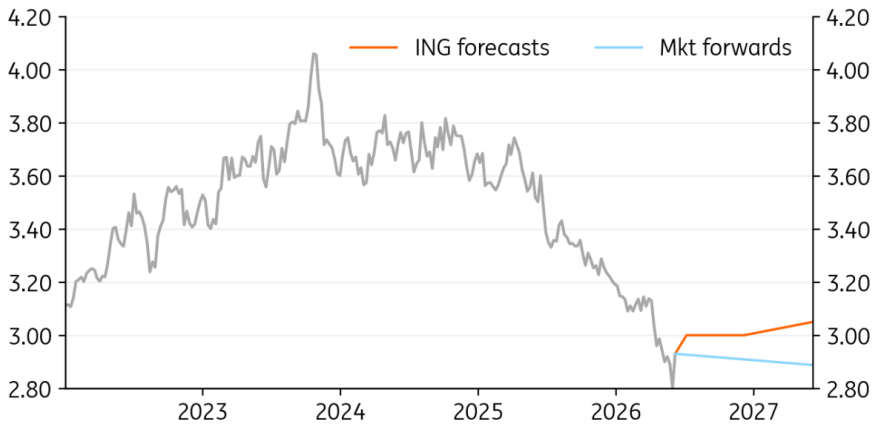


Source: Refinitiv, ING Forecasts

USD/ILS: Bank of Israel intervenes for first time since 2022

	Spot	One month bias	1M	3M	6M	12M
USD/ILS	2.9200	Bullish 	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.05

- We had felt that the Bank of Israel did not want USD/ILS to be trading under 3.00. Over the last month it intervened to the tune of \$800m and also cut rates by 25bp to 3.75%. Unlike elsewhere in the world, inflation is on target and the Bol is seen as having plenty of room to cut. The market has probably got ahead of itself, however, in pricing a further 150bp of easing.
- The FX intervention is the first since 2022 and quite a big deal. Previously it had been thought Washington had warned Israel away from intervention – that policy may have changed now.
- A stronger dollar and a tech world moving into frothy valuations leave the tech-sensitive shekel a little fragile this year.



Source: Refinitiv, ING Forecasts

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Article | 12 June 2026

COMMODITIES, FOOD & AGRI

What's next for US copper import tariffs

The US tariff decision on copper imports is weeks away, with the Commerce Secretary due to deliver a recommendation to President Donald Trump by 30 June. The market has already begun pricing the outcome. The COMEX-LME spread has widened to around \$400/t, suggesting the market continues to price meaningful tariff risk into US-delivered refined copper



Supply tightness, US tariff-driven stockpiling and AI-linked power demand are supporting copper prices

Where we are now

LME copper is trading near record highs, with prices up around 10% year-to-date and holding up well against a difficult macro backdrop. Strong US jobs data has reinforced expectations that the Federal Reserve will keep policy restrictive for longer, while renewed tensions involving Iran have weighed on broader risk sentiment.

Supply tightness, US tariff-driven stockpiling and AI-linked power demand are keeping copper more resilient than the broader complex, with the tariff decision now only weeks away.

What the tariff decision looks like

When President Trump announced a 50% tariff on copper in July 2025, refined copper was carved out. That exemption is now under review. The Commerce Secretary has until 30 June to

deliver an updated recommendation to Trump on whether and how to extend tariffs to refined copper. The original Commerce Department proposal called for a 15% tariff on refined copper imports effective January 2027, escalating to 30% in 2028.

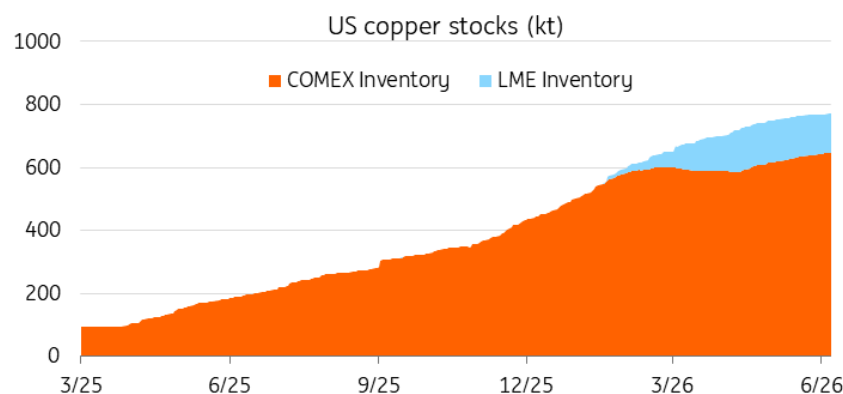
Earlier this month, Trump signed a proclamation adjusting the broader metals tariff framework – maintaining the 50% tariff on semi-finished copper products, lowering the domestic content threshold from 95% to 85% to qualify for preferential treatment, and broadening the scope to include additional semi-fabricated products such as electrical conductors and cables. New rates took effect 8 June. These changes are widely seen as preparatory steps ahead of the refined copper review, making it easier for importers to qualify for preferential treatment tied to domestically produced metal.

How the market has already repositioned

Since February, US copper imports have spiked in anticipation of the tariff deadline, encouraging additional shipments into the US and tightening supply in other regions.

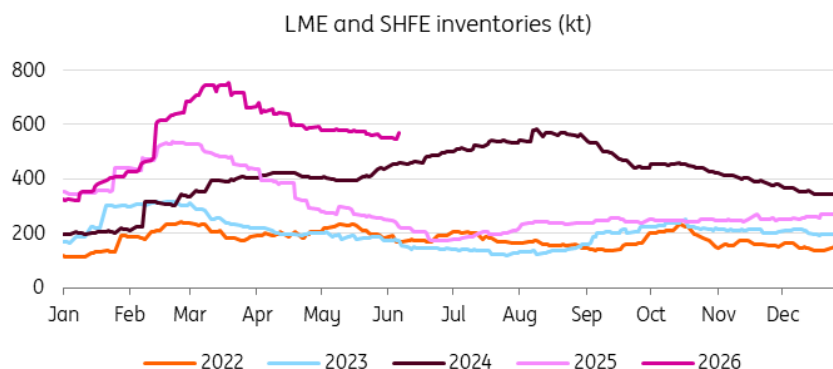
COMEX-registered inventories have risen to record highs. That build has come directly at the expense of LME and SHFE stocks, which have declined sharply over the same period.

COMEX stocks hit records, LME inventories also trend higher



Source: COMEX, LME, ING Research

Meanwhile ex-US inventories have declined sharply

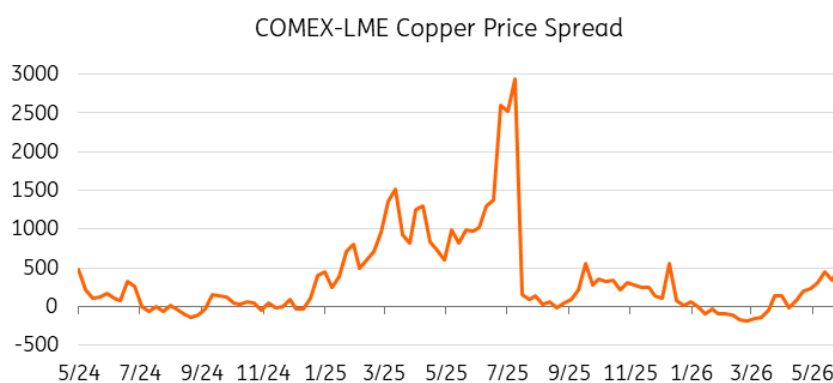


Source: LME, SHFE, ING Research

This is not a demand-driven inventory build. It reflects a geographic redistribution of available metal driven by tariff arbitrage. A significant volume of copper cathode is now economically 'locked' into the US market. While some of this metal could eventually be released if tariff expectations fade, the prospect of further trade policy measures means inventories are increasingly being held as strategic rather than 'arbitrageable'.

The COMEX-LME spread began re-widening from early 2026 as the 30 June deadline came into focus. It turned positive again in late March and has been climbing since, reaching around \$400/t in early June. At current levels, the spread is well below the peak of around \$2,937/t seen in late July 2025 when a 50% tariff on all copper was briefly feared. This suggests the market views a 15% phased tariff as a much more contained outcome.

COMEX-LME copper spread rewidens



Source: COMEX, LME, ING Research

What happens after the announcement

A confirmed 15% phased tariff from 1 January 2027 would likely increase the premium of COMEX over LME copper. In practice, both benchmarks would move higher. COMEX would be supported by stronger US import demand, while LME would also benefit as metal diverted away from the US tightens supply availability elsewhere.

The overall impact would be supportive for copper prices globally, although the larger move would likely occur in COMEX.

If the proposed increase to 30% in 2028 is brought forward or confirmed as a near-term policy objective, the premium could expand further.

A delay represents the clearest near-term downside risk for the spread, although the impact would likely be more limited than an outright rejection of tariffs. The arb would compress and the pace of inflows into COMEX would slow – but material already stockpiled in the US is unlikely to leave the market quickly. As long as tariff risks remain, a significant portion of those stocks is likely to remain effectively locked within the US market. The spread would narrow, but would probably settle at a structurally wider level than pre-2025 norms rather than collapsing back to parity.

An outright rejection of tariffs remains the most bearish case. US import demand would drop sharply, and with the stockpiling incentive removed, both benchmarks would likely come under pressure. US-held metal could then potentially re-enter the global market or at least stop being 'locked' in the US.

Supply outlook remains tight

We forecast the global copper market to move into a deficit of around 35kt in 2026, reflecting mine supply losses across Indonesia, Chile, the DRC and Zambia, alongside disruptions to Middle Eastern sulphur flows and sustained end-use demand in electrification and grid infrastructure. The tariff outcome does not change that underlying market balance.

However, it will determine how quickly the deficit becomes visible in exchange inventory data and how the price gap between COMEX and LME evolves.

We see LME copper broadly supported at current levels through 2Q, before easing modestly into 3Q and 4Q as the initial tariff stockpiling impulse fades and macro headwinds persist. The tariff announcement itself represents near-term upside risk to our near-term forecast. A front-loaded 30% tariff would put further upside in play. Conversely, a delay or outright rejection of tariffs represents the clearest downside risk to our view over the second half of the year.

The 30 June deadline and the COMEX-LME spread are the two indicators to watch most closely over the coming weeks.

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